Obsidian Markdown Cheat Sheet

Every Obsidian syntax with a copy button — wikilinks, callouts, embeds, tags, LaTeX, Mermaid — plus a free PDF and a vault-ready .md download

Updated July 2026 — every section verified against the official Obsidian Help

Or grab the file directly: **obsidian-markdown-cheat-sheet.md**

Obsidian supports all standard Markdown syntax plus the extensions below. See our Markdown Cheat Sheet for standard syntax.

Markdown Basics

Obsidian fully supports standard Markdown — headings, bold, and italic work exactly as they do in CommonMark.

Headings

Up to six levels; the number of # symbols sets the level shown in the outline.

```
# Heading 1
## Heading 2
### Heading 3
```

Bold

Double asterisks; double underscores (__text__) also work.

```
**bold text**
```

Italic

Single asterisks; single underscores (_text_) also work.

```
*italic text*
```

Source: **Obsidian Help** · Last verified 2026-07-18

Wikilinks (Internal Links)

Wikilinks connect notes by name inside double brackets — no file path required. Obsidian can update them automatically when you rename a note.

Basic Link

Link to another note

```
[[Page Name]]
```

Link with Alias

Link with custom display text

```
[[Page Name|Display Text]]
```

Link to Heading

Link to a specific heading; add more # symbols for subheadings

```
[[Page Name#Heading]]
```

Link to Block

Link to a specific block; type ^ after # to pick from suggestions

```
[[Page Name#^block-id]]
```

- Link text may not contain the characters # | ^ : %% [[ ]].
- Block references are Obsidian-specific and will not resolve outside Obsidian.

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Wikilinks vs Markdown Links

Both formats link between notes and render identically. Wikilinks are the default; disable "Use [[Wikilinks]]" under Settings → Files and Links for maximum interoperability.

Wikilink Format

Compact and vault-native; autocompletes when you type [[

```
[[Three laws of motion]]
```

Markdown Format

Portable to other Markdown tools; URL-encode spaces as %20

```
[Three laws of motion](Three%20laws%20of%20motion.md)
```

- Even with wikilinks disabled, typing [[still autocompletes — Obsidian then inserts a Markdown link.

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Embeds

Prefix any internal link with ! to embed the content inline instead of linking to it.

Embed Note

Embed an entire note

```
![[Note Name]]
```

Embed Heading

Embed a specific section of another note

```
![[Note#Heading]]
```

Embed Image

Embed a vault image; |100 sets the width, |640x480 sets width and height

```
![[image.png|100]]
```

Embed PDF

Embed a PDF; #page=N opens a specific page, #height=400 sets the viewer height

```
![[document.pdf#page=3]]
```

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Callouts

Add [!type] to the first line of a blockquote. Thirteen built-in types with aliases; an unknown type falls back to note.

Note

Information callout — the fallback for unknown types

```
> [!note]
> Content here
```

Tip

Aliases: hint, important

```
> [!tip]
> Content here
```

Warning

Aliases: caution, attention

```
> [!warning]
> Content here
```

Question

Aliases: help, faq

```
> [!question]
> Content here
```

Collapsible

A minus collapses the callout by default; a plus expands it

```
> [!note]- Title
> Hidden content
```

- Type identifiers are case-insensitive.
- Callouts nest and support Markdown, wikilinks, and embeds inside.

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Properties (YAML Frontmatter)

YAML between --- lines at the very top of a note. Property types: text, list, number, checkbox, date, date & time. Default properties: tags, aliases, cssclasses.

YAML Frontmatter

Note metadata; tags in YAML must be formatted as a list

```
---
title: My Note
tags:
  - project
  - draft
---
```

Aliases

Alternative note names for linking and search, one per line

```
aliases:
```

```
  - Project kickoff
```

- Markdown is not rendered inside property values — an intentional limitation.
- Wikilinks in text or list properties must be wrapped in quotes.
- Nested properties are not supported in the properties UI; view them in Source mode.

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Tags

Tags are clickable keywords. Add them inline with a # prefix or via the tags property.

Tag
Click a tag to search for it across the vault

```
#project
```

Nested Tag
Slashes create a hierarchy; searching tag:inbox also matches nested tags

```
#inbox/to-read
```

- No blank spaces — use camelCase, PascalCase, snake_case, or kebab-case for multiple words.
- A tag must contain at least one non-numeric character: #1984 is not valid, #y1984 is.
- Tags are case-insensitive: #tag and #TAG are treated as the same tag.

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Highlight

Highlight
Marker-style highlight; an Obsidian extension, not standard Markdown

```
==highlighted text==
```

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Strikethrough

Strikethrough

A GitHub Flavored Markdown extension, fully supported in Obsidian

```
~~strikethrough~~
```

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Comments

Text wrapped in %% is only visible in Editing view — it disappears in Reading view and on published sites.

Inline Comment

Hide part of a line

```
This stays visible %%this is hidden%% in the note.
```

Block Comment

Hide whole paragraphs

```
%%
Draft notes here.
Block comments span multiple lines.
%%
```

- Obsidian-only syntax — the %% markers render as literal text in other Markdown apps.

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Footnotes

Footnote

Named footnotes like [^note] also work; they still render as numbers

```
A sentence with a note.[^1]

[^1]: The referenced text.
```

Inline Footnote

Caret goes outside the brackets; works in Reading view only, not in Live Preview

```
An inline footnote.^[The note text goes here.]
```

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Tables

Basic Table

Cells need no alignment, but the header separator must contain at least two hyphens

```
| First name | Last name |
| --- | --- |
| Max | Planck |
```

Column Alignment

Colons in the separator row set left, center, or right alignment

```
| Left | Center | Right |
| :-- | :--: | --: |
| a | b | c |
```

- Escape a pipe inside a cell as \| — required for wikilink aliases and image sizes in tables.
- In Live Preview, right-click a table to add, move, or sort rows and columns.

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Math (LaTeX)

Math expressions render with MathJax using LaTeX notation.

Inline Math

Single dollar signs render math within a sentence

```
$e^{2i\pi} = 1$
```

Block Math

Double dollar signs on their own lines render a display block

```
$$
\sum_{i=1}^n x_i = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}
$$
```

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Mermaid Diagrams

A mermaid code block renders as a diagram — flowcharts, sequence diagrams, timelines, and more.

Flowchart

Rendered as a diagram in Reading view and Live Preview

````
```mermaid
graph TD
  Biology --> Chemistry
```
````

Sequence Diagram

One of many Mermaid diagram types Obsidian supports natively

````
```mermaid
sequenceDiagram
  Alice->>John: Hello John
  John-->>Alice: Hi Alice
```
````

- Attach the internal-link class to a node to turn it into a note link.

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Unsupported & Edge Behavior

Obsidian supports CommonMark, GitHub Flavored Markdown, and LaTeX math — with a few deliberate exceptions worth knowing before you port notes.

Markdown Inside HTML

Obsidian intentionally does not render Markdown syntax inside HTML elements

```
<div>
This **will not** be bold.
</div>
```

Block References Elsewhere

Block reference links only resolve inside Obsidian; they break in other Markdown tools

```
[[Note#^block-id]]
```

Underline

No Markdown syntax exists for underline; raw HTML works, but Markdown inside HTML is not processed

```
<u>underlined text</u>
```

- Single line breaks are treated as a continuation of the paragraph in Reading view, matching standard Markdown soft-wrap behavior.

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Markdown vs Obsidian: Compatibility

How Obsidian extends standard Markdown (CommonMark + GitHub Flavored Markdown), verified against the official Obsidian Help on 2026-07-18. For the standard syntax, see our **Markdown Cheat Sheet**.

Feature	Syntax	Standard Markdown	Obsidian	Notes
Headings, bold, italic	`# H1`, `**bold**`, `*italic*`	yes	yes	Core CommonMark syntax, identical in Obsidian.
Strikethrough	`~~text~~`	partial	yes	GFM extension, not part of CommonMark.
Highlight	`==text==`	no	yes	Obsidian extension; shows as literal == elsewhere.
Tables	`| A | B |`	partial	yes	GFM extension; Obsidian adds Live Preview table editing.
Task lists	`- [x] done`	partial	yes	GFM extension; any character inside the brackets marks a task complete in Obsidian.
Footnotes	`[^1]`	partial	yes	GFM extension; inline ^[...] footnotes are Obsidian-only.
Tags	`#tag`	no	yes	Renders as a plain heading-less #word elsewhere; searchable metadata in Obsidian.
Wikilinks	`[[Note]]`	no	yes	Obsidian-only; renders as literal brackets in CommonMark/GFM.
Embeds	`![[Note]]`	no	yes	Obsidian-only transclusion syntax.
Callouts	`> [!note]`	partial	yes	GitHub alerts support five fixed types; Obsidian adds 13 types, aliases, folding, and nesting.

Feature	Syntax	Standard Markdown	Obsidian	Notes
Comments	`%%hidden%%`	no	yes	Visible as literal text outside Obsidian; hidden in Obsidian Reading view.
Math	`$x^2$`	no	yes	Not in CommonMark or GFM core; Obsidian renders via MathJax.
Mermaid diagrams	```` ```merma id ````	partial	yes	GitHub.com also renders mermaid blocks; plain CommonMark/GFM treat them as code.
Properties (frontmatter)	`--- key: value ---`	no	yes	Not parsed by CommonMark/GFM; Obsidian turns the YAML block into typed note properties.
Markdown inside HTML	`<div>**text**</div>`	partial	no	Obsidian deliberately skips Markdown inside HTML elements; CommonMark processes inline Markdown around HTML.

Copyable Obsidian Markdown Examples

Meeting note with backlinks

Use frontmatter, internal links, and headings together for durable meeting notes.

```
---
tags: [meeting, roadmap]
---

# Product sync

Related: [[Roadmap]] and [[Launch checklist]]

## Decisions
- Ship the beta on Friday
- Follow up with [[Design review]]
```

Collapsible callout

Add a minus sign after the callout type to collapse long reference blocks by default.

```
> [!summary]- Research notes
> Key source: [[Competitor audit]]
> Next step: compare pricing pages.
```

Embedded section reference

Embed a specific heading when you only need one section from another note.

```
![[Project plan#Risks]]

See also: [[Project plan#Timeline]]
```

Free Obsidian Cheat Sheet PDF

Download the whole reference as a real PDF file — every wikilink, callout, embed, and Mermaid example on one clean sheet. Prefer to work inside Obsidian? Download the same reference as a vault-ready Markdown note, or copy it in one click — the page, PDF, and .md are generated from a single verified source. Prefer paper? Print the page directly and the layout hides navigation and buttons automatically. You can also copy any example into the Markdown to PDF converter for a custom version.

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Useful Shortcuts

`Cmd/Ctrl + N`	New note	`Cmd/Ctrl + O`	Open quick switcher
`Cmd/Ctrl + P`	Command palette	`Cmd/Ctrl + E`	Toggle edit/preview

`Cmd/Ctrl + Click`	Open link in new pane
`[[`	Start wikilink

Frequently Asked Questions

What is Obsidian?

Obsidian is a powerful knowledge base and note-taking application that stores Markdown files locally on your device, with features like wikilinks, graph view, and extensive plugins.

How are wikilinks different from regular Markdown links?

Wikilinks use double brackets [[like this]] and automatically link to other notes in your vault by name, without needing the full file path.

Can I use regular Markdown in Obsidian?

Yes! Obsidian supports all standard Markdown syntax plus its own extensions like wikilinks, callouts, and embeds.

Is there an Obsidian cheat sheet PDF?

Yes — click the Download PDF button to get the free Obsidian Markdown cheat sheet as a real PDF file, ready to save or print. No signup or email required. You can also print the page directly with Ctrl/Cmd+P.

What Obsidian Markdown syntax should beginners learn first?

Start with wikilinks, headings, tags, callouts, and embeds. Those five patterns cover most Obsidian vault workflows before you add plugins or advanced templates.

Obsidian Deep Dives

Obsidian Callouts

Obsidian Wikilinks

Every callout type, collapsible callouts, custom titles, and nesting

Link notes, headings, and blocks, plus embeds and wikilinks vs Markdown links

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